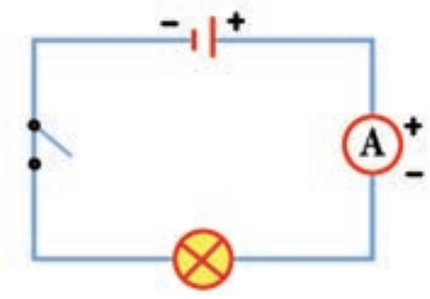
2.5. Electric circuit

It is difficult to draw a realistic diagram of this circuit. The electrical appliances you use at home have even more difficult circuits. Can you draw realistic diagrams of such circuits which contain many bulbs, cells, switches and other components? Do you think it is easy? It is not easy.

Scientists have tried to make the job easier. They have adopted simple symbols for different components in a circuit. We can draw circuit diagrams using these symbols.

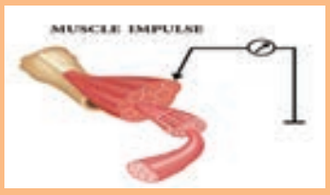
Symbols for bulbs, cells and switches are shown in figure.

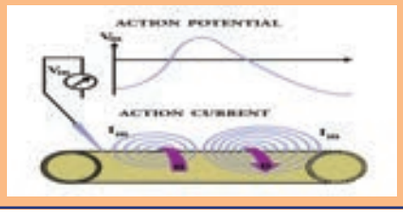


In a cell, the longer line denotes the positive (+) terminal and the short line denotes the negative (-) terminal. We shall use these symbols to show components in the circuits we draw. Such diagrams are called circuit diagrams.



All muscles of our bodies move in response to electrical impulses generated naturally in our bodies





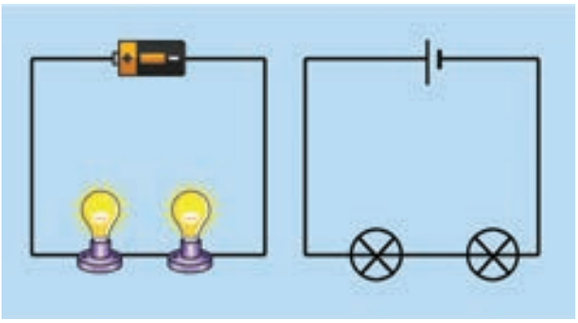
2.5.1. Types of electrical circuits

In the above experiment, we make a circuit with a bulb and a cell. We make only one kind of the circuit with a cell and a bulb. But we can make many types of circuits if we have more than one bulb or cells by connecting these components in different ways .

2.5.2. Series circuit

Two kinds of circuits can be made with two bulbs and a cell. In this experiment we shall make one of them and study it.

Look at the circuit with two bulbs, and a cell and a switch given here (Figure)



It is clear from the circuit diagram, that the two bulbs are connected one after the other. The circuit diagram shows the sequence of the bulbs and cell, not their real position. The way in which the bulbs have been connected in this circuit is called series connection.

Now make the circuit by joining the two bulbs and cell. Do both the bulbs light up? Do both glow equally bright? If one glows less bright, will it shine more brightly if we change its place in the sequence? Change the sequence of bulbs and notice.

Sometimes bulbs appear to be similar can differ from each other. So, similar looking bulb do not always glow equally bright when connected in series. The circuit can be broken at several places. For example, between the cell and the bulb, between the two bulbs etc.

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